PROPOSAL · MAY 2026

Save up to 90% on AI tokens. Make productivity provable.

Built on a fork of an established open-source AI cost optimizer that already cuts token consumption by **60–90%** across every major AI coding tool. TokenShelf adds a **verifiable productivity layer** on top — every consenting builder earns an **official certified badge** with their score: portable, signed, theirs to display. Builders adopt for the savings; a.team gets the productivity proof as the network adopts naturally.

Four use cases · one certified badge

USE CASE 01

Personal projects

Private by default. Builders track their own AI-native productivity over time. Visible to no one unless they choose to share.

visible to: **builder only**

USE CASE 02

a.team interviews & vetting

Builders opt in to show TokenShelf scores during onboarding or recruiter conversations. A verifiable proof point that beats "I'm good with AI tools."

visible to: **builder · a.team recruiter**

USE CASE 03

a.team engagements

Embedded as the productivity-proof layer. Account managers see the signal; buyers see only what the builder approves per engagement.

visible to: **builder · account manager · buyer (consent)**

USE CASE 04

Client-accepted projects

When a buyer adopts TokenShelf alongside the engagement, every receipt is contractually verifiable by both sides. Higher trust, fewer disputes.

visible to: **builder · buyer · a.team**

OPEN DAEMON
The capture tool is open source & auditable. Builder project code stays private to them and their client.

SECRETS FILTERED
Tokens, passwords, credentials stripped before anything leaves.

NO LATENCY PENALTY
Smaller prompts run faster; measurement is out-of-band.

BUILDER-OWNED
Score and prompts: show or hide per audience, anytime.

A trust layer no other talent network can offer.

a.team sells elite AI talent measured by outcomes. Embedded as a.team's productivity-proof layer, TokenShelf gives every engagement a receipt buyers can verify themselves — and gives builders credit for AI-native work that today gets dismissed as "just using a tool."

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01 **A defensible differentiator.**

No other talent network can *prove* its builders are more productive with AI — and no other network's builders deliver engagements with materially lower AI spend by default. The moat: cost savings that pull adoption, network consent that earns trust, open code that anyone can verify.

02 **Buyers verify the math themselves.**

Every receipt is cryptographically signed. Buyers don't have to take a.team's word for it — they re-verify independently. The signal works even if TokenShelf or a.team disappears tomorrow.

03 **A portable certified badge builders own.**

Builders who participate earn an *official certified badge* with their score — signed, shareable, and theirs to keep. It travels across LinkedIn, portfolios, and future engagements. A real reason to stay on a.team's network, especially for the AI-native builders other networks are actively recruiting.

WHAT A.TEAM SEES

Per-engagement metrics

- **Time** invested per session & engagement
- **Model spend ($)** & tokens used — input, output, cache
- **Overall score (%)** from objective signals
- Account-manager view for retention & renewal
- × Never: prompts unless the builder explicitly shares them

WHAT BUYERS SEE

With builder consent

- Same metrics for the engagement they paid for: time, $, tokens, score (%)
- Receipts & certified badge they can re-verify themselves
- Session-level breakdown only if the builder approves
- × Never: prompts unless the builder chooses to show them

Builder decides what's visible — score, prompts, everything. Show or hide per audience, anytime, from a single command.

THE ASK · AN OPEN CONVERSATION

A **30-minute conversation** with a.team engineering and product, then a small beta with consenting builders. From there, commercial structure, technical depth, and rollout shape are open to whatever fits a.team — I'd rather match the model that works for the network than commit to a number or a timeline on this page.